

Nielsen Heuristic Evaluation – aTendy (Attendance App)

No	Heuristic	Description of the issue	Screenshot	Severity	Suggested improvement
1	H1-1: Simple & natural dialog	Several routes and controls are visible but not real. The route <code>/student/attendance</code> is registered in the router (<code>src/App.tsx:38</code>) but renders only a development placeholder – <code><h1>Hi, amma ATTENDANCE</h1></code> (<code>src/pages/student/AttendancePage.tsx:1-9</code>). The “Forgot password?” link on the login form is a dead anchor <code>href="#"</code> (<code>src/pages/LoginPage.tsx:224-226</code>). The “Notifications” button on the live lecture page has no <code>onClick</code> (<code>src/pages/teacher/lectures/LectureDashboardPage.tsx:204-210</code>), and “End Session” only calls <code>navigate('/teacher/courses')</code> without ever closing the session in the backend (<code>LectureDashboardPage.tsx:152-155</code>).	—	4	Replace the <code>/student/attendance</code> stub with a real page or remove its route; either implement Forgot Password, Notifications, and End Session, or remove the controls. Dead UI trains users to distrust the rest of the interface.

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2	H1-2: Speak the users' language	Even after the recent localization sweep, the Mark Attendance dialog still falls back to hard-coded English error strings: <pre>setError('Lecture not found') , 'You are not enrolled in this course' , 'Attendance already marked' , and the generic 'Something went wrong' (src/pages/student/DashboardPage.tsx:160-163, 167).</pre> A user who selects Arabic, Russian or Finnish gets a fully translated dialog that suddenly speaks English the moment something goes wrong.	—	3	Move these strings into the <code>student.*</code> namespace of <code>en.json / ar.json / ru.json / fi.json</code> and call <code>t()</code> in the switch on <code>response.status</code>.
3	H1-3: Minimize users' memory load	The Attendance History page (<code>src/pages/student/AttendanceHistoryPage.tsx</code>) renders an unfiltered, unpaginated table of every record. There is no search box, no course filter, no date range picker, and no sort control. After several weeks the student is forced to scroll the entire history and remember which row was the lecture they're looking for.	—	2	Add a top-of-page filter bar: free-text search, course dropdown, date range, and a Status filter (Present / Absent). Persist the selection in the URL so users can bookmark a filtered view.

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4	H1-4: Consistency	Loading states are visually inconsistent across the app. The Student Dashboard centres a <code><CircularProgress/></code> on the page (<code>src/pages/student/DashboardPage.tsx:174-178</code>); the Lecture Dashboard renders the plain text “Loading lecture...” with no spinner (<code>src/pages/teacher/lectures/LectureDashboardPage.tsx:157-163</code>); the Courses, Lectures, and Enrollments tables embed inline “Loading...” text inside a single <code>TableCell</code> (<code>CoursesPage.tsx:124-127</code>, <code>LecturesPage.tsx:91-94</code>, <code>EnrollmentsPage.tsx:194-197</code>). Three different conventions for the same concept.	—	2	Pick one pattern (skeleton rows for tables, spinner overlay for full pages) and apply it consistently. The translation keys are already in place (<code>teacher.*.loading</code>).
5	H1-5: Feedback	The “Marked / Present” and “Unmarked / Pending” counters on the Lecture Dashboard always render the placeholder <code>t('common.placeholder.empty')</code> (i.e. <code>--</code>) regardless of the live state (<code>src/pages/teacher/lectures/LectureDashboardPage.tsx:309, 337</code>). The page already loads an <code>attendances</code> array via <code>loadAttendances</code> and computes <code>totalPresent / totalAbsent</code> (<code>LectureDashboardPage.tsx:144-150</code>); those values just aren’t wired into the two counters. During a live session the teacher has no live numeric feedback and must scroll to the “Present students” list to count by hand.	—	3	Replace the hard-coded <code>t('common.placeholder.empty')</code> with <code>totalPresent ?? '--'</code> and <code>totalAbsent ?? '--'</code>; consider polling <code>loadAttendances</code> every 5–10 s so the counters update as students join.

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6	H1-6: Clearly marked exits	Auth-flow navigation is asymmetric. The Login page renders a clear escape route (“Don’t have an account? Sign up” linking to <code>/signup</code> , <code>LoginPage.tsx:238-241</code>), but the Sign-up page provides no equivalent link back to Login – the only way out is the browser back button (<code>src/pages/SignupPage.tsx</code> , full file). A user who reaches <code>/signup</code> by mistake or who already has an account has no in-page exit.	—	2	Add a translated <code>Link</code> at the bottom of the Sign-up form: “Already have an account? Sign in” → <code>/</code> , mirroring the wording already in <code>login.noAccount</code> .
7	H1-7: Shortcuts	The “Remember me” checkbox on the Login page is rendered, translated and toggleable (<code>LoginPage.tsx:209-223</code>), but its value is never read inside <code>handleSubmit</code> and is never sent to the auth API (<code>LoginPage.tsx:43-63</code>). The control is purely cosmetic; users who tick it expecting an extended session are silently misled.	—	3	Either wire the flag through to the auth API (longer JWT lifetime / refresh token), or remove the checkbox until the feature exists.
8	H1-8: Precise & constructive error messages	Login error mapping covers only HTTP 401 (<code>LoginPage.tsx:38-41</code>); every other failure (network, 5xx, 429, 403) collapses into the single generic <code>errors.unknown</code> (“An unknown error occurred. Please try again later.”). Sign-up only maps HTTP 500 (<code>SignupPage.tsx:75-78</code>), so the very common case of 409 “email already registered” and 400 “validation failed” also collapse to “unknown”. The user can’t tell whether to change their email, retry, or contact support.	—	3	Add explicit translated mappings for at least: 409 → “Email already registered – sign in instead” (with a <code>/</code> link), 400 → field-level errors, network failure → “Check your internet connection”, 5xx → “Server error – please try again later”.

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9	H1-9: Prevent errors	The Sign-up form treats every required field as “present means valid”: <code>validateForm()</code> only checks <code>email.trim() !== ''</code> etc. (<code>SignupPage.tsx:64-69</code>) – there is no email-format check, no password-length check, and no password-strength indicator. The translation files already contain ready-to-use copy for <code>errors.invalidEmail</code> and <code>errors.passwordTooShort</code> (<code>languages/en.json:57-58</code> , mirrored in <code>ar.json</code> / <code>ru.json</code> / <code>fi.json</code>), but the form never references them. Users only learn the rules after a server-side rejection, which collapses to “unknown” because of issue #8.	—	2	Add a regex or <code><input type="email"></code>-based check; require <code>password.length >= 6</code> ; bind both to MUI <code>error</code> + <code>helperText</code> using the existing translation keys.
10	H1-10: Help and documentation	The application has no <code>404 / Not Found</code> page – the router defines explicit routes only and has no <code><Route path="*" /> fallback(<code>src/App.tsx:27-59</code>).</code> Visiting any unknown URL (typo, stale link, deleted resource) renders a blank page with no recovery. There is also no Help / About / FAQ link in the sidebar (<code>src/layouts/menuElements.tsx</code>) or AppBar (<code>src/layouts/private.tsx</code>), and no recovery flow for forgotten passwords (see issue #1) – a user locked out of their account has no in-app path back in.	—	3	Add <code><Route path="*" element={ <NotFoundPage /> } /></code> with a translated message and a “Go to dashboard” button; add a Help item in the sidebar linking to a docs page or in-app FAQ; implement a real password-reset flow.